he never managed to slake.

. Banarasidas, *Ardhakathanak* (A Half Story), trans. Rohini Chowdhury (Penguin Books, 2009).

. Freer Gallery of Art: https://asia.si.edu/object/F1960.27

. Jahangir, *The Jahangirnama: Memoirs of Jahangir, Emperor of India*, ed. and trans. W.M. Thackston (Oxford University Press with the Smithsonian Institution, 1999).

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 3, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).

. Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).

. Translator's note in Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. In 1586, Abul Fazl had drawn lots with Birbar to go to Swat, wanting to 'shut the mouths of . . . envious persons'. In 1591, when he fell ill, he wrote that 'as I was inclined to perform military service, my disposition . . . became sad'. The next year, when Abul Fazl was promoted to a mansab of 2000, he wrote, 'I hope that I may return some thanks by the tongue of action.' Now was his chance to prove himself.

. Technically, Chand Bibi was regent to the king but 'secretly that chaste lady was ruler', as Abul Fazl writes.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3. It may be, as some historians speculate, that it was not Daniyal but his ataliq, Abdur Rahim, who wanted to prevent Abul Fazl from enjoying too much success in the Deccan. The two men became bitter rivals over the following months.

. Ibid.

. Shaikh Illahdad Faizi Sirhindi, 'Akbarnama', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 6 (Trübner and Co., 1875).

. Translator's note in *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

.Fr. Pierre Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits: An Account of the Jesuit Missions to the Court of Akbar*, trans. C.H. Payne (First published 1926; Low Price Publications, 2008).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Shaikh Illahdad Faizi Sirhindi, *Akbarnama*.

.*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Ibid.

. Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Ibid. The Jesuit chronicle of events – accepted by some historians, rejected by others – alleges that it wasn't valour but deceit that won Asirgarh. 'His inability to approach the fort greatly vexed the Mogor,' they write, so that Akbar, 'finding the lion's skin ineffective, changed it for that of the fox.' Bahadur was lured out of the fort with false promises, his generals were bribed; the whole affair, indeed, was a damning example of Akbar 'making use of the arts of cunning and deceit, of which he was a master'. The Jesuits may have had a slight prejudice in the matter, however, since Akbar had asked them to try and get him Portuguese ammunition from Goa – having left behind his own siege-guns, not anticipating a battle against Khandesh. The Fathers had refused, and Akbar, furious, ordered them out of his sight. The priests were planning to leave when one of Akbar's amirs told them not to go – it would only enrage the emperor further. Instead, he said to lie low until the storm blew over. 'They followed his advice, and in a short time the King's wrath subsided, and they were completely restored to his favour.' See Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*.

. Translator's note in *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

.With Daniyal went 3000 Badakhshanis 'who had recently come from Turan' and seem to have been serving a year's duty in the Deccan as price of admission to Hindustan. Ibid.